

US Tanks: 1941-45

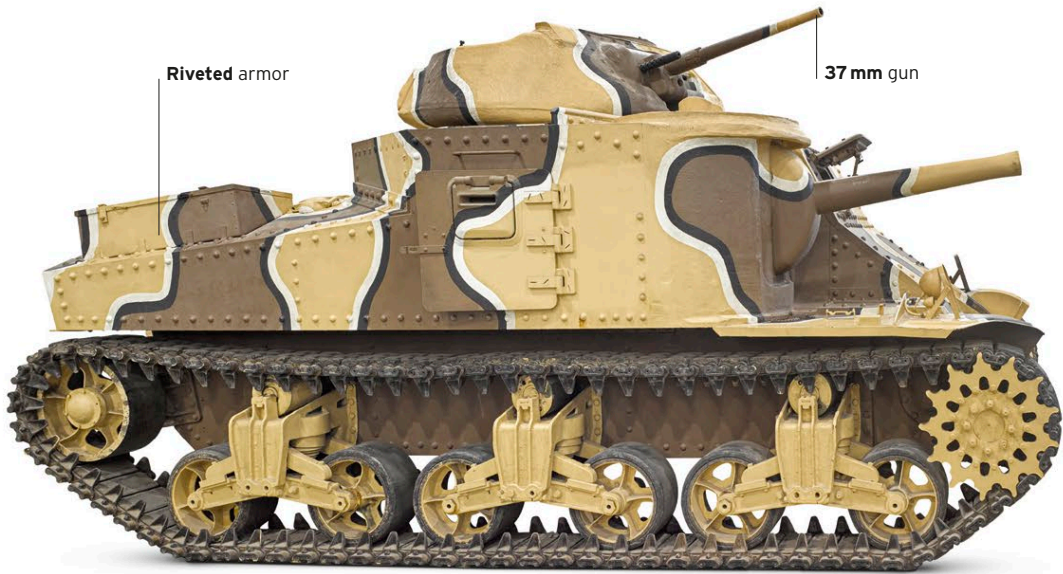
In 1940, the US had around 350 modern tanks in service. The well-developed American automotive industry turned its hand to tank manufacturing, and expanded massively. By 1945 it had built over 60,000 vehicles and supplied them to every Allied power. Successful design components were kept from model to model to ease production. The M4 Sherman in particular proved capable of being upgraded extensively. American tanks were robust, well built, and powerful: while German designs were sometimes more powerful on paper, US crews' good tactics, logistics, and training were often enough to prevail.



△ **M3A1 (Stuart)**

Date	1940	Country	USA
Weight	14.2 tons (12.9 tonnes)		
Engine	Continental R-670-9A gasoline, 250hp		
Main armament	37 mm M6 L/56.6 gun		

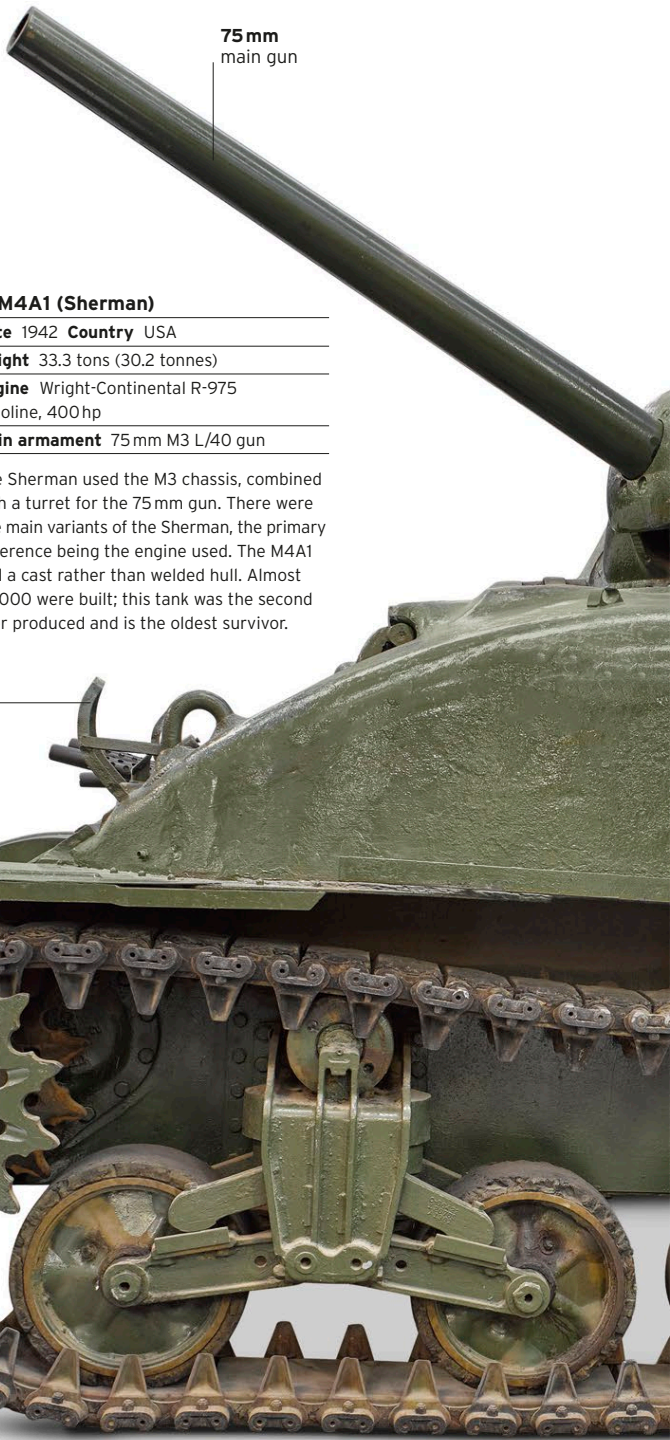
The Stuart was an improved version of the 37 mm-armed M2A4. It benefited from mass production techniques that made it reliable and easy to repair. It was used by all the Allied powers in every theater of war. By 1944 it was obsolete as a tank, but remained in service for reconnaissance.



△ **M3 (Grant)**

Date	1941	Country	USA
Weight	30 tons (27.2 tonnes)		
Engine	Wright Continental R-975 gasoline, 340 hp		
Main armament	1 x 75 mm M2 L/31 gun, 1 x 37 mm M5 L/56.5 gun		

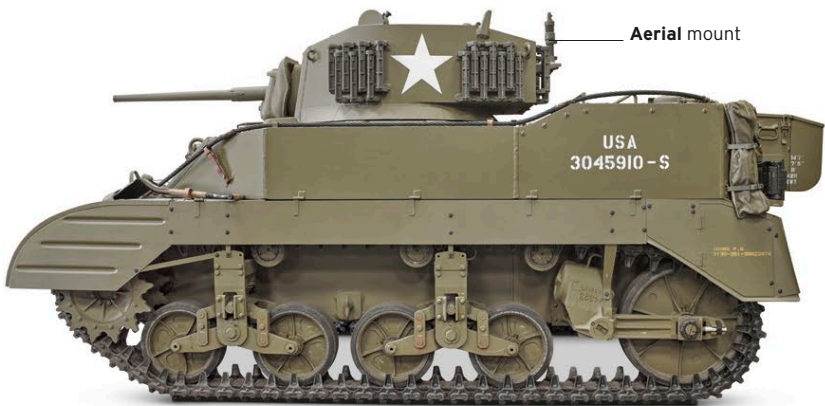
The M3 stemmed from an urgent need to field a 75 mm gun before a suitable turret was ready. The gun was mounted in a sponson on the hull, which limited its field of fire. The M3 kept the successful engine and Vertical Volute Suspension System (VVSS) from the M2 medium. British M3s used a modified turret and named it the Lee. The original version was named the Lee.



▷ **M4A1 (Sherman)**

Date	1942	Country	USA
Weight	33.3 tons (30.2 tonnes)		
Engine	Wright-Continental R-975 gasoline, 400 hp		
Main armament	75 mm M3 L/40 gun		

The Sherman used the M3 chassis, combined with a turret for the 75 mm gun. There were five main variants of the Sherman, the primary difference being the engine used. The M4A1 had a cast rather than welded hull. Almost 50,000 were built; this tank was the second ever produced and is the oldest survivor.



△ **M5A1 (Stuart)**

Date	1942	Country	USA
Weight	16.9 tons (15.3 tonnes)		
Engine	2 x Cadillac Series 42 gasoline, 148 hp each		
Main armament	37 mm M6 L/56.6 gun		

The M5 was developed from the M3 to free up R-670 engines for aircraft. The hull was also redesigned to improve protection. The new engine arrangement allowed more space inside for the crew and made the tank quieter. Unlike the M3, the M5 was not used by the Soviet Union, but both were used for the same roles in British and American service.